

# Chatura Dissanayake

## Information Design & Communications Specialist

### PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Information Design and Communications Specialist with 6+ years of experience producing data stories, reports, and visual communications for the UN, government, and research institutions. I work across the full pipeline, from raw datasets to published narrative – to make complex information accessible to broad audiences.

### WORK EXPERIENCE

#### Communications Designer (Consultant)

**Govt. of Sri Lanka – Dept. of National Planning** (Jun 2025 – Jul 2025)

- Led end-to-end design of the Public Investment Programme 2026–2030, translating complex national economic data for senior policymakers.
- Collaborated with cross-functional government teams to develop interactive charts, maps, and structured annexes for official publication.
- Delivered a cohesive, accessible report under tight national timelines for digital and print distribution.

#### UN National Volunteer Specialist (Contract)

**UN Resident Coordinator's Office, United Nations Sri Lanka** (Mar 2025 – Jun 2025)

- Led information design for the 2024 UN Annual Results Report, coordinating data inputs from eight UN agencies into a single coherent narrative.
- Produced multilingual policy briefs and visibility assets for 4,000+ stakeholders, including the Prime Minister.
- Maintained strict UN branding standards across all strategic reporting and high-visibility communications.

#### Communications Designer (Full-time)

**Ideas Marketing Agency (Sydney/Remote)** (Sep 2024 – Feb 2025)

- Reduced user drop-off rates by 30% through end-to-end UX/UI design and research for nonprofit digital platforms.
- Developed high-fidelity wireframes and prototypes in Figma to improve platform usability and user flow.
- Built scalable design modules and brand systems, cutting internal production time by 50%.

#### Senior Communications Designer (Full-time)

**Verité Research, Colombo, Sri Lanka** (Jan 2024 – Sep 2024)

- Produced strategic communications outputs including press releases and infographics, expanding research visibility in national public debate.
- Managed 150+ data-driven narratives featured in national media and mentored junior designers on output quality.
- Collaborated with interdisciplinary teams to translate complex policy findings into clear, accessible formats.

#### Junior Communications Designer (Full-time)

**Verité Research, Colombo, Sri Lanka** (Sep 2022 – Jan 2024)

- Supported design and dissemination of high-profile campaigns and research publications across print and digital platforms.
- Translated technical research findings into accessible content for policymakers, media, and the public.
- Strengthened layout precision and visual storytelling across 150+ research outputs and communications materials.

\*Click the blue starred titles to view full interactive project portfolios.

### TOOLS & SYSTEMS

**Design & Prototyping:** Figma, Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign, Canva.

**Data & Visualisation:** Tableau, Power BI, RawGraphs, Flourish, Sankeymatic, P5.js.

**Web & Interactive:** HTML/CSS, JavaScript, GitHub, Vercel, Webflow, WordPress.

**Communications & Media:** Mailchimp, Meta Business Suite, LinkedIn, MS Teams.

**Analytics & Feedback:** Google Analytics, YouTube Studio, Social Media Insights.

**Project & Workflow:** Notion, Trello, Slack, MS Office, Google Workspace.

### COMMUNICATION PROJECTS

#### UN 2024 Annual Results Reports\*

Led information design coordinating data across 8+ UN agencies.

#### Public Investment Programme 2026–2030\*

Visualized government investment data for official national policy reports.

#### YouTube Entertainment Channel

Scaled news platform to 2M+ views via data monitoring and sentiment analysis.

#### Sri Lanka's Drug Crisis Interactive\*

Developed scrollytelling data story exploring national drug policy and health.

#### How a Single Storm Broke Sri Lanka\*

Independent data story on disaster impact, recovery, and aid failure.

### RELEVANT EDUCATION

#### International Relations

BCIS, Sri Lanka (2025 – Incomplete)

#### French Language and Literature

Alliance Française (2025 – Incomplete)

#### Design and Visual Communications

Academy of Design (2021 – Incomplete)

#### High School Diploma in Arts

Trinity College Kandy, Sri Lanka (2019)

### PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

#### Essential Design Principles for Tableau,

University of California, Davis

#### Google Analytics Certification, Google

Digital Academy

#### Enterprise Design Thinking, Team

Essentials for AI, IBM

#### Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner,

Team Essentials for AI, IBM

#### Fundamentals of Digital Marketing, Google

Digital Academy

### LANGUAGES

**Sinhala** – Mother tongue.

**English** – C1 (Full professional proficiency).

**French** – A2 (Basic user).

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# Chatura Dissanayake

Information Design & Communications Specialist

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am applying for the position of Digital Communications Manager at the British High Commission in Colombo. I am a communications and information design specialist with experience working across the UN, the Government of Sri Lanka, and policy research institutions. I bring a specific set of skills in digital content creation, data storytelling, and translating complex information for public audiences.

At the UN Resident Coordinator's Office, I led information design for two major institutional publications, coordinating inputs from eight UN agencies and producing visibility assets, including the Prime Minister. At the Department of National Planning, I delivered the Public Investment Programme 2026-2030, a national policy report, under tight government deadlines. At Verité Research, I contributed to over 150 research outputs, working directly with policy analysts to make complex findings accessible to media, policymakers and the general public.

The digital communications side of this role, content creation, social media management, analytics and data-driven storytelling, is work I do regularly. My independent Cyclone Ditwah data story, a fully self-initiated interactive site built to communicate the disaster's impact to a general audience, demonstrates what I can produce when I own the full process from idea to publication. My portfolio is at [chaturadissanayake.vercel.app](https://chaturadissanayake.vercel.app).

I am fully proficient in English and have a strong understanding of the Sri Lankan media landscape. I am applying because this role sits at the exact intersection of communications, policy, and digital work that I have been building towards.

Thank you for considering my application.

Yours sincerely,  
Chatura Dissanayake

 +94 76 223 9177

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